16. Ibid.

17. *The Imperial Gazetteer of India*, XXI (1908): 280.

18. Sharma and Misra (2003): 110–12.

19. A summary of the later evidence in the form of Gupta gold coins, sculptural remains, and temples is available in Chakrabarti (2005): 85.

20. For the excavations at Eran, Sharma and Mishra (2003): 102–6.

21. *Dipavamsa* VI.16. Oldenberg (1879): 147.

22. *Mahavamsa* XIII.10–11. Geiger (1912): 88–9.

23. Thapar (1973): 22–3.

24. The Sri Lankan texts, for example, do not mention the battle of Kalinga that Ashoka himself refers to at great length in Rock Edict XIII.

25. For a summary of the arguments, Guruge (1993): 44.

26. This is the argument of Thapar (1973): 23.

27. Guruge (1993): 40.

28. See Dhauli Separate Rock Edict I. Hultzsch (1925): 94 and 97.

29. Ancient Vidisha is also known as modern Besnagar. For excavations, Mishra and Sharma (2003): 90–4.

30. Marshall, Foucher, and Majumdar, *The Monuments of Sanchi* (1940): vol. I, 2.

31. See Lamotte (1988): 56.

32. *Mahavamsa* V.40. Geiger (1912): 29.

33. *Dipavamsa* VI.21–2. Oldenberg (1879): 148.

34. ‘When Mahinda was ten years old, his father put his brothers to death; then he passed four years reigning over Jambudvipa. Having killed his hundred brothers, along continuing his race, Ashoka was anointed king in Mahinda’s fourteenth year. *Dipavamsa* VI.21–2. Oldenberg (1879): 148.

35. Strong (1989): 208–9.

36. Ibid.: 209.

37. *Dipavamsa* VI.22. Oldenberg (1879): 148. This is unlikely to be true since, as we shall see later, Ashoka does mention the households of his siblings in his epigraphs.

Notes to Chapter 5: The End and the Beginning